

Word family: **panic / panics / panicked / panicking / panicky**

Base word: panic

Plural: panics

Past tense: panicked

Past participle: panicked

** -ing form:** panicking

Related form: panicky

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / adjective-related form (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “It did not rush or **panic**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **panic** means to **suddenly become extremely frightened or anxious and lose calm, clear control of your reactions**.

The turtle did not react fearfully or chaotically. It remained calm.

繁體中文： **因突然的恐懼或焦慮而慌張、失去冷靜和清晰判斷**

中文翻譯：

> “It did not rush or **panic**.”

「牠沒有急躁，也沒有**驚慌 / 慌亂**。」

Here:

panic = 因害怕或緊張而突然失去冷靜

1. **panic = sudden extreme fear/anxiety (名詞) — 恐慌；驚慌**

Meaning: A sudden, very strong feeling of fear or anxiety that makes it difficult to think or act calmly.

Practice 1

> “A wave of **panic** spread through the crowd.”

「一陣**恐慌**在人群中蔓延。」

Practice 2

> “She felt a sudden sense of **panic**.”

「她突然感到一陣**驚慌**。」

panic = 突然而強烈的恐懼或焦慮，使人難以保持冷靜或理性

Common:

- * feel panic
- * sudden panic
- * widespread panic
- * in a panic

2. **panic** = become suddenly frightened and lose control (動詞) — 驚慌；慌亂

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 3 — Original

> “It did not rush or **panic**.”

「牠沒有急躁，也沒有**驚慌**。」

Practice 4

> “Don’t **panic** if something goes wrong.”

「如果出了問題，不要**慌張**。」

Practice 5

> “He **panicked** when he could not find his passport.”

「他找不到護照時便**慌了**。」

panic = 因突然害怕、焦慮或壓力而失去冷靜並作出慌亂反應

This is the main verb meaning.

3. **panic** = cause someone to panic (及物) — 使恐慌；嚇慌

****Panic**** can also be transitive.

Practice 6

> “The loud noise ****panicked**** the horses.”

「巨響把那些馬****嚇慌了****。」

Practice 7

> “The warning ****panicked**** some passengers.”

「那個警告令部分乘客感到****恐慌****。」

****panic someone = 令某人或動物突然極度害怕、焦慮或慌亂****

For core counting, I would merge this with Meaning 2 as the causative form of the same concept.

4. ****panic = widespread social/financial fear (集體) — 恐慌 ; 恐慌性反應****

****Panic**** can refer to fear spreading through a large group and causing irrational or rushed behaviour.

Practice 8

> “The rumour caused public ****panic****.”

「那個謠言引起了公眾****恐慌****。」

Practice 9

> “There was ****panic**** in the market after the announcement.”

「消息公布後，市場出現****恐慌情緒****。」

****panic = 大量人同時因恐懼或不確定而產生的集體慌亂****

This is still the noun fear sense, just on a larger scale, so I would not split it into a separate core meaning.

5. ****panic buying / panic selling (慌亂行為) — 恐慌性搶購 / 拋售****

In fixed compounds, **panic** can modify behaviour caused by collective fear.

Practice 10

> “The shortage led to **panic buying**.”

「短缺引發了**恐慌性搶購**。」

Practice 11

> “Investors engaged in **panic selling**.”

「投資者出現**恐慌性拋售**。」

panic + action = 因恐懼而急速、非理性地採取某種行動

These are productive compounds built from the same core noun/adjective-like idea, not separate lexical meanings.

Related form: **panicky**

Panicky means easily frightened or currently showing signs of panic.

Practice 12

> “She sounded **panicky** on the phone.”

「她在電話中聽起來很**慌張**。」

Practice 13

> “Try not to get **panicky**.”

「盡量不要變得**驚慌失措**。」

panicky = 容易驚慌，或當下表現得非常慌亂的

Important distinction: **panic vs fear**

fear

is the broad emotion of being afraid.

panic

is stronger and more sudden, usually involving loss of calm or control.

> “He felt fear.”

= 他感到害怕。

> “He panicked.”

= 他慌了，開始失去冷靜。

So:

fear = 害怕

panic = 驚慌失措

Important distinction: **panic vs worry**

worry

is usually longer-lasting concern or anxiety.

panic

is sudden, intense, and more overwhelming.

> worry about the exam

> panic when you realize you are late

Different intensity and timing.

Important distinction: **panic vs rush**

This is especially relevant to your sentence.

rush

means act or move too quickly.

panic

means become extremely frightened/anxious and lose calm.

The turtle did neither:

- > it did not move hurriedly
- > and it did not react fearfully.

So the two verbs are not synonyms.

Important distinction: **panic vs nervous**

nervous

= anxious, tense, or uneasy

panic

= much stronger, often involving a sudden loss of control

A person can feel nervous without panicking.

Countability note

Panic is usually uncountable when referring to the emotional state:

- > "There was panic in the room."

But it can be countable in some contexts referring to an episode:

- > "He had a panic."

This is much less common than expressions such as:

- > "He had a panic attack."

For learners, the safest core pattern is to treat **panic** as generally uncountable in the emotion sense.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **panic**
* **panicked**
* **panicking**
* **panicky**

Useful constructions and compounds include:

* in a panic
* don't panic
* panic someone
* public panic
* panic buying
* panic selling

The family is relatively small, so the main learning value lies in the contrast between the noun emotional state and the verb meaning “become suddenly frightened and lose calm.”

The Golden Manual says small families should remain small, while useful figurative and compound extensions should still be checked without inflating the core sense count.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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panic — noun	突然而強烈的恐懼或焦慮，使人難以保持冷靜或理性
panic — verb	因突然害怕、焦慮或壓力而失去冷靜並作出慌亂反應
panic someone	令某人或動物突然陷入恐慌；與 verb sense 相同
public/market panic	群體因恐懼或不確定而產生的集體慌亂；屬於 noun sense
panicky	容易驚慌，或當下表現得非常慌亂的
panic buying/selling	因恐慌而作出的急速、非理性搶購 / 拋售行為

For your original sentence

> “It did not rush or **panic**.”

The exact meaning is:

****panic = 因害怕或壓力而突然失去冷靜、變得慌亂****

So the sentence means:

> **牠沒有急着逃走，也沒有因為我們靠近而驚慌失措。 **

This strengthens the description of the turtle as calm, steady, and graceful.

For your database, I would count **2 genuinely useful core meanings** for **panic**:

1. **noun — sudden extreme fear/anxiety**
2. **verb — suddenly become extremely frightened and lose calm**

I would merge causative **panic someone** into #2 and keep **panicky, panic buying, panic selling** as family/compound extensions rather than inflate the core count.